Le lingue indoeuropee. Edited by Anna Giacalone Ramat & Paolo Ramat. Bologna: Il Mulino, 1993; 'nuova edizione', 1994. Pp. 546.

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This volume represents a compendious survey of the Indo-European languages, by diverse hands. A detailed table of contents (pp.5-10) is followed by a brief editorial introduction (11-15) and listings of abbreviations (16-18); then follow three chapters on general Indo-European topics (I. "Antichità indoeuropee" [Enrico Campanile], 19-43; II. "Il proto-indoeuropeo" [Calvert Watkins], 45-93; III. "La famiglia linguistica indoeuropea: prospettive genetiche e tipologiche" [Bernard Comrie], 95-121); the bulk of the book consists of chapters on individual IE languages and language families, as follows: IV. on Sanskrit (Romano Lazzeroni, 123-149), V. on Iranian (Nicholas Sims-Williams, 151-179), VI. on Tocharian (Werner Winter, 181-196), VII. on Anatolian (Silvia Luraghi, 197-224), VIII. on Armenian (Roberto Ajello, 225-254), IX. on Greek (Henry Hoenigswald, 255-288), X. on Latin (Edoardo Vineis, 289-348), XI. on Italic (Domenico Silvestri, 349-371), XII. on Celtic (Patrick Sims-Williams, 373-407), XIII. on Germanic (Paolo Ramat, 409-440), XIV. on Slavic (Henning Andersen, 441-479), XV. on Baltic (William Schmalstieg, 481-506), and XVI. on Albanian (Shaban Demiraj, 507-530). The volume concludes with a subject index and an index of names; regrettably, there is no word index, and no systematic treatment of IE *Restsprachen.*

R&R write (11-12) that they hoped to portray the 'state of research' in each IE language or language family, and to produce a book that would appeal not only to students of IE linguistics, but to historical linguists generally. To enhance expository clarity (especially for the latter group), the language-survey chapters generally follow a unified traditional format (i.e., external history, then phonology, then morphology, etc.), and editorial cross-references enhance the cohesiveness of these treatments; at the same time, the individual authors were given considerable latitude in matters of exposition, notation, and content, such that each chapter reflects an 'autonomous treatment', concluding with 'an essential bibliography'.

R&R's conception was noble, and the resulting compendium is a work of undeniable richness and value. The execution of this grand design, however, is flawed, and the work is far less useful than it could have been. While the book

Diachronica 14:1 (1997), 167–172. DOI 10.1075/dia.14.1.13vin
ISSN 0176–4225 / E-ISSN 1569–9714 © John Benjamins Publishing Company

has benefited from such editorial control as was imposed, it would have benefited still more from a higher degree of control than seems to have been possible. Thus, to address some of the editors' most basic hopes and claims: to begin with, the book does not successfully portray the 'state of research' in each IE language area. While some authors make attempts in this direction, noting scholarly trends and areas of current controversy, others content themselves with rehearsing basic facts, sometimes in rather outmoded fashion. R&R correctly note (p.12) that authors' inconsistencies in notating the IE laryngeals generally do not imply any real linguistic differences, and pose little difficulty for the reader; but R&R fail to warn unsuspecting readers that some authors frame their presentations in non-laryngealistic (or 'pre-laryngealistic') formats, surely a source of confusion to the unsophisticated student or the non-Indo-Europeanist user.[1] Nor does each chapter provide 'an essential bibliography', clearly a prime desideratum for such a survey: though one would have hoped for listings that minimally include basic handbooks, lexica, and other fundamental resources, individual authors' conceptions of what bibliography to provide vary widely in practice (some egregious examples below).

Many of the language-survey chapters are in any case excellent. The best of them (to my mind: the chapters on Iranian, Greek, Celtic, Germanic, Slavic, and Armenian) present, generally within twenty to thirty-five pages, carefully executed and sometimes masterful surveys of the essential linguistic material, with a sufficiency of well-chosen examples and with thoughtfully compiled bibliographical indications.[2] In contrast to the chapters just noted, several others are disappointing, especially those on Sanskrit, Latin, and Tocharian. In view of R. Lazzeroni's numerous contributions to Indic studies, his chapter on

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[1] A simple example: a reader perusing the useful subject index would find (p.535) references to discussions of "Desinenze verbali", among them "desinenze del perfetto": but if one follows these up, the 1sg. *-h_2a (*-h_2e) and 2sg. *-th$_2$a (*-th$_2$e) of Watkins (p.77) and the 1sg. *-H_2e and 2sg. *-tH_2e of Hoenigswald (p.282) flatly contradict the pre-laryngealistic *-a and *-tha of Lazzeroni (p.139; similarly Vineis [*-a, *-ta], p.329).

[2] There are always, of course, details with which one might quibble; to pick a chapter more or less at random: in R. Ajello's survey of Armenian, the section on "I primi documenti" (p. 228) fails to mention the important pre-Christian material preserved by Movsēs Xorenac'i (on which, in the context of IE poetics, see now Watkins 1995: 167, 251ff.); Skt. *cad-* "fall" (p.234) does not exist — A no doubt refers to *śad-*, formerly transcribed *çad-*, and indeed the chapter is rife with transcription errors; loosely-phrased statements like "*smokru-, attestato da lit. *smākras*" (where the IE *u*-stem does not in fact appear as such in the Lithuanian form) are bound to be confusing; contra IE *-iśḱe/o- as a basis for the Arm. subjunctive (p.248) see Klingenschmitt (1982:41ff.) — a work not to be found in A's bibliography! — and Vine (1993); or, in P. Ramat's chapter on Germanic: the bibliography includes several classic works of the vintage of Meillet (1930), but oddly omits Prokosch (1939), as well as lexical resources like Seebold (1970) and Lehmann–Feist (1986); and so on.

Sanskrit strikes me as uncharacteristically careless and superficial; e.g., in the survey of Skt. literary documents, the discussion of "Vedic" (§3.1, 126-127) lengthily considers (via trendy terminology and reference to L's published work) the problem of how to characterize the difference between the "vedico antico" of the RV and the "vedico recente" of the AV ("la differenza diatopica si riduce a una differenza diastratica"), but oddly omits all mention of Vedic prose, or even the Vedic recensions; among various problems with L's treatment of phonology (cf. above on his "pre-laryngealistic" notation of the perfect endings), the sloppy statement (p.129) that "Lo sch(e)wà indoeuropeo (ə) passa a *i* in ogni posizione" is at best a misleading oversimplification (see Jamison 1988 on the distribution of Skt. *i* and *ī* < IE *H), and other important laryngeal-related patterns are notably absent (especially the prominent vowel-plus-laryngeal lengthening of the type *sūnára-* < *$h_1$su-$h_2$ner-); incredibly, the section on phonology contains no mention of Brugmann's Law, even though portions of the morphology cannot be understood without it (e.g., L's own examples *rājān-* < *rēǵon- [p.133], and "la vocale tematica *a*/*ā* (< **e*/*o*): *bhar-a-ti, bhar-ā-mas*" [p.137]); the discussion of the consonantal inventory (p.131) confuses the velar nasal with *anusvāra*; the discussion of the sigmatic aorist (138) mentions the *s*-formant but not the lengthened grade (thereby obscuring L's aorist paradigm of *ni-* [sic, rather: *nī-*] "lead", 144: anāiṣam etc.); the one-page section on syntax (146-147) is annoyingly superficial (L could at least have referred to Hock 1991, with rich bibliography); and L's bibliography finds room for no less than four references to L's own publications, but omits such fundamental works as Whitney's grammar and the two Vedic grammars of Macdonell, the lexica of Grassmann, Macdonell, and Monier-Williams, and standard editions, translations and commentaries of Vedic texts, not to mention important resources like Gotō (1987), Jamison (1983), or Narten (1964).[3] L's chapter, moreover, is execrably proofread.[4]

E. Vineis' 60-page account of Latin (much of it in a smaller type-face!) is so bloated with extraneous detail as to seriously compromise its utility, in a book of this sort. Again, the presentation is essentially 'pre-laryngealistic' (with IE forms like *dhūmos, *g^{w}īwos, *pibeti etc., or at best *krewəs), and many of V's assertions or formulations are questionable or outmoded — these being embedded, to be sure, in a swath of perfectly correct and uncontroversial

[3] In this last respect, L comes off badly in comparison with N. Sims-Williams' immediately following chapter on Iranian: here we find a carefully prepared (and even *annotated*) bibliography, including the standard lexica, grammars and text editions of Avestan and Old Persian.

[4] E.g. p.131: *dhumás* for *dhūmás*, similarly p.134: *duras* for *dūras* and p.135/136 *bis* (i.e. 3 times in all!): *yuyam* for *yūyam;* also p.133: Oscan *Núvulanús* for *Núvlanús*, p.142: Greek *hágnós* for *hagnós*, etc.; most confusingly: the nonsensical "*dviṣṇte* < *dviṣṇte*" (p.144).

material. It would be otiose to detail such problematic items here, though it can be noted that V's treatment of the archaic inscriptional material is particularly disappointing.[5] V's "Riferimenti bibliografici" are strong on work by Italian scholars (14 of 36 items), but unfortunately lack the Latin etymological dictionaries of Walde–Hofmann and Ernout–Meillet, as well as works like Schrijver (1991) or Panagl & Krisch (1992). Finally, neophyte readers are again ill-served by a text replete with errors and oversimplifications like "la radice *bhu-*" (297; sic, for *bhū-, *bhuh$_2$- or *bhuH-), or with a wildly inconsistent notation for Sanskrit *a*-stems (thus *aśva*, *sana-* and *navas* all on p. 303).

In contrast to Vineis' expansive treatment, the 16-page chapter on Tocharian — from the pen of Werner Winter, one of the world's most distinguished scholars of Tocharian — disappoints in its laconism: the sections on phonology and morphology are essentially synchronic descriptions (with only the most minimal examples) mainly couched in terms of Common Tocharian, and give little sense of the IE background of most features. When W writes, in his final sentence, that "il tocario può recare importanti contributi per una ricostruzione del proto-indoeuropeo", readers will be stunned, since such a perspective fails utterly to emerge from W's bare-bones treatment. At least W provides a fairly full listing of the principal handbooks (though one misses some notice of the journal *Tocharian and Indo-European Studies*).

Among the book's most useful contributions are the three introductory essays — by the late E. Campanile, by C. Watkins, and by B. Comrie — which provide well-organized and highly informative surveys: Campanile considers the methodology of cultural reconstruction, then examines individual topics (IE religion, sacrifice, the family, poetics, etc.); Watkins provides a virtuosic and richly detailed sketch of PIE grammar; and Comrie, after noting possible areal and genetic affiliations of IE, surveys IE grammar from the point of view of phonological, morphological and syntactic typology.

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[5] Among other problems, V takes no account of Wachter 1987, and he reveals a tendency toward unjustifiably categorical assertions: V's transcription of CIL I^2 364 (293) contains several errors, and ignores Wachter's demonstration of **[D]iouei** and **uiitam**; the immediately following list of alleged phonological features of non-urban Latin includes "*r* > *d* nei contesti [-r # d-]", but both **opeinod** (CIL I^2 547) and **pretod** (CIL I^2 365) are suspect, as Wachter has shown; despite V (p.316), forms of the type **matrona** (CIL I^2 378) do not necessarily show a trace of the old nom. pl. in *-ās*, with "caduta 'rustica' di *-s* finale" (cf. Wachter); in V's discussion of the perfect endings (p.330), he states that Lat. 3pl. *-ēre* "ha riscontri in indo-iranico e soprattutto in tocario", without mentioning Hittite *-ēr* or the problematic OLat. **steterai**; V disingenuously refers (p.333) to a "suffisso *-sē-*" for the imperfect subjunctive, as if this explained anything about the origin of this mysterious formant (see, e.g., Jasanoff 1991, Meiser 1993), similarly "il suffisso **-ndo-*" (334) for the gerundive; etc., etc.

Emblematic of the book as a whole are the maps included with most chapters: an excellent idea, but in some cases very poorly executed. This is, to conclude, a useful and important collection, but something of a missed opportunity: it is not the authoritative *vade mecum* of the Indo-European languages that still remains to be written.

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